

Moving 46,000 people to Windows 11 across 750 locations

How HSBC turned an operating-system upgrade into a global change programme that strengthened security and prepared its workforce for a cloud-connected future.

Users	Locations	Delivery	Focus
46,000	750	Phased regional waves	Security and adoption

Overview

HSBC carried out one of the largest end-user technology transformations in its history: a global rollout of Windows 11 to 46,000 users across 750 locations.

The programme set out to modernise the desktop experience, strengthen security, and support a more agile, cloud-connected workforce across the bank's global operations.

It was never only an operating-system upgrade. The bank treated it as a strategic transformation that aligned its workplace technology with its digital-banking vision.

The challenge

A change of this size in a global bank has to meet three demands at once. Business operations could not be disrupted. Every device and process had to satisfy HSBC's stringent security and regulatory standards. And tens of thousands of employees, working in different regions and languages, needed to feel confident with a new working environment.

The approach

The rollout was delivered in a structured, phased way. Each region, from London to Hong Kong, New York and Dubai, moved through controlled waves, with incremental regional go-lives rather than a single cutover.

Automation and analytics were used to monitor deployment success, so the programme could see how each wave was performing. Communication, training and adoption frameworks supported every region.

A dedicated User Adoption Office coordinated communications, training and engagement. It helped employees understand new features such as Snap Layouts, Teams integration and enhanced security controls.

What was delivered

Global deployment	Windows 11 deployed to 46,000 users across 750 locations worldwide.
Modern device refresh	Legacy hardware replaced with secure, high-performance devices optimised for Windows 11.
Enhanced security baselines	TPM 2.0, BitLocker and advanced identity management, aligned with HSBC's global cybersecurity policies.
ServiceNow integration	Automated incident, request and change workflows for rollout tracking and support.
User adoption programme	Multilingual training, a digital champions network and feedback loops to support a smooth transition.
Performance and reliability	Reduced boot times, improved endpoint stability and a better remote-work experience.
Governance and reporting	Global dashboards covering rollout progress, compliance and user satisfaction.

Security and compliance

Windows 11's security architecture was mapped directly to HSBC's enterprise risk framework. This kept the programme in line with financial-sector regulations and internal audit standards.

Across all regions, the rollout strengthened endpoint protection, identity assurance and data-loss prevention.

Outcomes

- A modernised desktop experience for 46,000 users.
- Improved endpoint security and compliance posture.
- Reduced operational overhead and support demand.
- Better productivity and collaboration through Microsoft 365 integration.
- A scalable foundation for future digital-workplace initiatives.

Strategic impact

The rollout positioned HSBC to offer a consistent, secure and high-performance user experience worldwide. It reinforced the bank's commitment to innovation, resilience and digital transformation, and gave employees the tools to work smarter, faster and more securely in a modern financial-services environment.